

LumiCube

Funding: US\$ 58,602 pledged of US\$ 6,934 goal

Link: <http://dgit.in/lumicube>

Lumicube from the company Abstract Foundry is an LED cube kit for Raspberry Pi. Under all the dazzle of the RGB LEDs, there's a fair bit of tech for your money. The cube has three sides of RGB LEDs (192 individually controlled LEDs). These LEDs are packed into a laser-cut acrylic enclosure that is designed specifically for the Raspberry Pi 3 and Raspberry Pi 4. The supported Raspberry Pis can neatly slot inside the enclosure. The base variant of the device buys you the enclosure, a



2W speaker, microphone, and the RGB LED panels, but for a bit more dough you can also get a 2-inch 320 x 240 resolution IPS display, some buttons, and a light and gesture sensor. Users can also choose to

opt for a temperature/humidity sensor, pressure sensor and an IMU (inertial measurement unit) sensor. The cube is more than just a desk prop. With a few lines of Python code and some sensors, you can program the cube to show live traffic, weather, news, create a home assistant, and even a custom controller. The cube can even notify you of important events, provide calming background sounds, or even automate some routine tasks. The possibilities are endless.



Tidbyt

Funding: US\$ 475,201 pledged of US\$ 40,000 goal

Link: <http://dgit.in/tidbyt>

A device that looks like a lovechild between retro lo-fi displays and modern-day smartphone widgets, Tidbyt is a nifty display that extracts useful information from your smartphone and displays it on a 64 x 32 RGB LED display. The retro display is encased in a walnut wood enclosure that is honestly a great little piece of home decor as well. The device can display pretty much anything from your smartphone as long as it fits on the archaic display. It is Bluetooth and Wi-Fi enabled and you can use your Android or iOS smartphone to set which apps show information on the display. Examples include a clock, calendar, custom text messages, stock prices, cryptocurrency value, and even low-res photos that look pretty amusing on the display. These apps can be scheduled and cycled according to the user's preference via the Tidbyt app. Additionally, if you're well-versed in Python, you can even write your own custom applets and experiences for Tidbyt using its existing API and SDK. Users can choose multiple apps to cycle between and can set the time that each app's information will display on the screen. Tidbyt is even smart enough to follow the sun, and adjust its own brightness according to the time of day, with it being brighter in the morning and gradually getting dimmer as the sun sets in the evening.

ChessUp

Funding: US\$ 461,289 pledged of US\$ 30,000 goal

Link: <http://dgit.in/chessup>

Developed by Square Off, a Mumbai-based startup, ChessUp is a 'smart' chessboard of sorts with a built-in chess instructor that lights up the possible moves on a chessboard. The company defines the board as a "chess coach, analyst and fierce opponent all rolled into one". The high-tech chess board comes equipped with light indicators that highlight all the possible moves and their strength - Green for good choices, Blue for possible mistakes, and Red for out-



right blunders. There's also smart touch sensors incorporated into the board that detects when a player has touched and released a piece. Moreover, it comes with Bluetooth 5 connectivity that connects to your device for online and onboard gameplay. You can connect with oppo-

nents online with instant matchmaking or even play ranked games (where the assists are disabled for obvious reasons). ChessUp is powered by the latest version of Stockfish AI that analyses your gameplay and automatically matches your proficiency level when you play against it to put up a fair

fight. The board can also teach players moves such as the Queen's Gambit, the Sicilian Defense, King Rook Endgame, Stafford Gambit and others. There's also a supported app that gives users access to stats and analytics such as game archives, game analysis, rating, and more.